Austrian Second-Hand / Used-Goods Market: Feasibility Research Dossier for Mercatino Entry — with Italy Comparison

TL;DR

- **The Austrian used-goods market is real, growing, and largely un-consolidated at the physical-retail level (~€2 billion/year, with second-hand projected to grow ~10%/year to 2030), but it is dominated by online marketplaces (willhaben, Vinted, refurbed) and charity/social-economy shops (Caritas carla, Volkshilfe ReVital) — there is no incumbent commercial general-secondhand consignment chain comparable to Mercatino, which is simultaneously the core opportunity and the core warning sign.**
- **Consumer demand is mainstream: 73% of Austrians have bought second-hand and ~60% did so in the past 12 months, spending an average of €211/year; motivations (giving products a second life 74%, price 71%) and top categories (clothing, books/media, furniture/homeware) closely mirror Italy's Osservatorio — but the two datasets are NOT directly comparable (Austrian figures come from a Repubblika retail-association survey plus a top-down €2bn estimate; Italy's €27.2bn/65% figure is a dedicated 2,001-interview Ipsos Doxa observatory that includes used vehicles).**
- **Recommendation: proceed to a staged, evidence-gathering pilot focused on the consignment (conto vendita) model's Austrian-specific unknowns — VAT margin-scheme structuring, retail-rent economics in Graz/Linz/Salzburg, and sourcing competition from charity shops — rather than a full national rollout; the €2bn "market" is mostly online and social-economy value that a physical for-profit consignment store does not automatically capture.**

Key Findings

1. **Market size**: The Handelsverband (Austrian Retail Association) estimates the Austrian second-hand market at "rund 2 Milliarden Euro jährlich" (~€2 billion/year). A Boston Consulting Group study cited by the Handelsverband (November 2025) reports the second-hand market growing ~10%/year and expanding three times faster than the primary market. These are top-down estimates, not audited market-sizing.
2. **Consumer adoption**: 73% of Austrians have ever bought second-hand; ~60% in the past 12 months; average spend €211/year (up from €195 in 2024); 18% buy second-hand at least monthly; 36% plan to buy more.
3. **Channels**: Online platforms dominate (55% of buyers buy there regularly); flea markets 32%; second-hand/vintage shops 31%.

4. **Online competition is intense and extremely well-capitalized**: willhaben (3.8m+ monthly users, 13m+ listings, valued ~€500m, new co-owner Sprints Capital as of 2025), Vinted (€10.8bn marketplace GMV, profitable, ~€8bn valuation), refurbed (Vienna-based, €3bn cumulative GMV, profitable since March 2025), plus Shpock, eBay Kleinanzeigen and Facebook Marketplace.
5. **Physical retail is dominated by charities**: Caritas carla (33 shops in Styria alone; shops across all dioceses) and Volkshilfe ReVital (21 shops in Upper Austria alone). These are social enterprises with donated (free) stock — a structurally cheaper cost base than a consignment shop that pays sellers.
6. **No commercial general-secondhand franchise chain exists in Austria** comparable to Mercatino. This is whitespace but also signals barriers.
7. **IKEA Austria** runs a "Zweites Leben" buyback + resale program (7,000+ products bought back in one year, +50% YoY), showing retailer-led resale is scaling.
8. **Regulation is a tailwind**: the EU Ecodesign Regulation (ESPR) ban on destruction of unsold textiles (large firms from 19 July 2026), Right to Repair, and Austria's Bundes-Abfallwirtschaftsplan 2023 all prioritize re-use. Austria's VAT margin scheme (§24 UStG) lets dealers tax only the margin on used goods bought from private individuals.
9. **Site economics**: Salzburg has Austria's highest per-capita purchasing power (~€30,954 in 2026 per RegioData) but also very high rents; Graz and Linz are materially cheaper.

Details

1. Market Size & Trends (Austria)

The most-cited figure is the Handelsverband's estimate of **"rund 2 Milliarden Euro jährlich"** (~€2bn/year), attributed to Managing Director Rainer Will. Against Austrian GDP of roughly €480bn this implies ~0.4% of GDP — but this is a rough top-down estimate, not a bottom-up market study, and its category scope is unclear (it appears to exclude used vehicles, unlike Italy's headline figure).

The **~10%/year growth to 2030** figure comes from a Boston Consulting Group study cited (not published) by the Handelsverband in its 3 November 2025 press release: *"laut einer kürzlich veröffentlichten Studie der Boston Consulting Group wächst der Second-Hand-Markt bis 2030 um 10 % pro Jahr und damit dreimal so schnell wie der sonstige Einzelhandel."* Importantly, the underlying BCG analysis is its **secondhand-luxury study (with Vestiaire Collective)**: as summarized by Revenue Brew (6 Nov 2025), *"the secondhand market is growing 10% annually and is expanding three times faster than the primary market for luxury goods… the value of the secondhand luxury market will hit $360 billion by 2030."* **The dossier should therefore flag that (a) this is a secondhand citation, and (b) the 10% figure originates from a global luxury-resale study, not an Austria-wide general-goods forecast.** An earlier BCG figure (2020) projected the second-hand *fashion* market growing 15–20%/year.

Statista's "ReCommerce" outlook provides category-level modelled estimates for Austria (furniture, fashion), but these are proprietary model outputs, not official statistics.

Category breakdown (2025 Repubblika/Handelsverband survey — share of buyers purchasing each category): adult clothing 38%; books/films/media 33%; toys 22%; furniture & home 21%; household goods & appliances 19%; phones/computers/tablets 15%; sporting goods 15%; children's clothing 15%.

2. Consumer Behaviour (Austria)

Primary source: **Handelsverband "Consumer Check," conducted by Repubblika Research** (note: the user's brief referred to "IHaM" for the ~1,000-respondent survey; the November 2025 second-hand study is by **Repubblika Research for the Handelsverband** — IHaM at JKU Linz runs separate retail-climate and general consumption studies. This naming distinction should be corrected in the dossier).

Key 2025 figures:

- 73% have ever bought second-hand; ~60% in the past 12 months
- Average annual spend: €211 (2025), up from €195 (2024)
- 18% buy at least monthly; 36% plan to buy more often; only 7% less often
- Resale side: 3 of 4 Austrians have resold items; average €171/year earned; mostly clothing/shoes (45%), books/media (43%), household goods (39%); 79% via online marketplaces
- Top motivations: giving products a second life (74%), price advantage vs. new (71%), plus sustainability and finding items no longer available new
- **Regional per-capita annual second-hand spend (2025 Handelsverband):** Lower Austria & Burgenland highest at €242; Carinthia & Styria €219; Salzburg & Upper Austria €205; Vorarlberg & Tyrol €196; Vienna lowest at €190
- Channel preferences: online platforms (Willhaben, Vinted, Refurbed) 55% regular buyers; flea markets 32%; second-hand/vintage shops 31%
- 70% would welcome in-store second-hand offerings from mainstream retail; 72% find refurbished products interesting

Age-cohort (Gen Z / Millennial / Gen X / Boomer) breakdowns for the Handelsverband second-hand data could not be retrieved directly; an older Statista/BCG figure said 39% of Austrians had bought second-hand in 2019/2020. Cohort-level Austrian second-hand data is a **research gap** to fill via primary sources (IHaM or Statista Consumer Insights).

3. Online Marketplace Competition

- **willhaben.at**: Austria's dominant general marketplace. **3.8m+ monthly users, 13m+ listings** (real estate, jobs, auto, and a free C2C marketplace for goods including clothing, furniture, electronics). Founded 2006. In March 2025, Styria Media Group and London

growth investor **Sprints Capital** formed a 50:50 JV that bought out Adevinta's stake; per Trending Topics (3 March 2025), Adevinta's 50% was worth "etwa 250 Mio. Euro," implying a **~€500m valuation** (per Bloomberg), i.e. "ein halbes Unicorn." Deal closed Q2 2025. Sprints also backs Vinted, Revolut, Back Market and Chrono24. An older figure cited 8.5m+ ads on the goods marketplace. willhaben is the single most important competitor/complementary channel — it is where most Austrians both source and resell.

- **Vinted**: Fashion-led (now expanding to electronics, home, collectibles). Per Vinted's official 2025 results: **marketplace GMV €10.8bn (+47% YoY vs €7.3bn in 2024), ~€1.1bn annual revenue, €62m net profit, €151m adjusted EBITDA**; valued at ~**€8bn** after an April 2026 €880m secondary share transaction. Its European markets had ~28.1m monthly active users (Jan 2025). Cheaper shipping than willhaben; strong with younger sellers. vinted.at draws ~1.8m+ visits/month; users cross-shop Sellpy.
- **refurbed**: Vienna-founded (2017) refurbished-electronics marketplace. Per its March 2026 release, refurbed **surpassed €3bn cumulative GMV in less than twelve months after passing the €2bn mark in April 2025**, with **>40% annual GMV growth**, 10m+ products sold over nine years, and presence in 11+ markets (expanding into 13 more, reaching ~486m consumers). It has been **profitable since March 2025** (per brutkasten), following a ~20% workforce reduction and a €50m funding round in October 2025. Not a direct competitor to a general consignment shop, but it owns the "refurbished electronics" niche.
- **Shpock**: Vienna-origin marketplace (formerly Schibsted-owned, later acquired by Russmedia Equity Partners); has lost ground to willhaben and Vinted in Austria.
- **eBay Kleinanzeigen / Facebook Marketplace**: present, but willhaben dominates locally.
- **Social-economy online**: WIDADO (Caritas online marketplace), sogutwieneu.at.

4. Physical/Offline Second-Hand Retail Landscape

(a) Charitable/social-economy operators dominate physical second-hand:

- **Caritas "carla" shops**: nationwide across dioceses. Graz-Seckau (Styria) alone has 33 shops; Upper Austria 4–5; plus shops in Salzburg, Tyrol, Vienna/Lower Austria, and Burgenland (2). Sell donated clothing, household goods, books, furniture, antiques. Also provide labor-market reintegration (Transitarbeitsplätze).
- **Volkshilfe ReVital shops**: 21 in Upper Austria alone; ReVital is a quality-checked re-use label (esp. electrical goods). Also the VOIX vintage-fashion store in Linz.
- **RepaNet / Re-Use Austria**: umbrella network coordinating re-use operators; runs member market surveys.

(b) Independent commercial dealers: antique dealers, vintage shops, Altwarenhändler (second-hand/junk dealers), house-clearance operators, flea markets. Altwarenhandel is a free trade (freies Gewerbe) in Austria but carries a legal duty to verify and document the

provenance of purchased goods (anti-stolen-goods obligation under §154 GewO). These are typically one-person businesses.

(c) Commercial franchise/chain models: **None identified** for general second-hand goods in Austria comparable to Mercatino. IKEA's Zweites Leben is retailer-owned resale, not a franchise. This is the whitespace Mercatino would enter.

BOKU/BMK 2023 "Grundlagenstudie Re-Use im Möbelsegment" (furniture-only, commissioned by BMK, led by Gudrun Obersteiner at BOKU's Institute of Waste Management) identified **187 stationary second-hand furniture providers** in Austria. Regional density (providers per 100,000 inhabitants, population as of 1 Oct 2022):

Bundesland	Providers	Per 100k
Vienna	59	3.0
Styria	40	3.2
Upper Austria	31	2.0
Salzburg	15	2.6
Vorarlberg	9	2.2
Tyrol	10	1.3
Carinthia	6	1.1
Burgenland	6	2.0
Lower Austria	11	0.6
Austria	**187**	—

Styria (3.2) and Vienna (3.0) are densest; Lower Austria weakest (0.6). This is furniture-only; general/clothing/electronics categories were not mapped — a data gap.

5. IKEA & Retailer Second-Hand Initiatives

IKEA Austria runs the **"Zweites Leben" Rückkaufservice** (buyback) and **Zweite-Chance/Zweites-Leben-Shop** resale, both in-store and online. Customers sell back used IKEA furniture for an IKEA gift card (IKEA Family members get +15%); goods are refurbished and resold at reduced prices. IKEA reported 7,000+ products bought back in Austria in one year (+50% YoY) and aims to be a "circular business" by 2030. The Handelsverband notes furniture

and fashion retailers increasingly add "Pre-owned"/"Pre-loved" sections. This validates demand but also means Mercatino would compete with well-known brands' own resale channels.

6. Regulatory & Policy Context

- **EU Ecodesign for Sustainable Products Regulation (ESPR, EU 2024/1781)**: bans destruction of unsold textiles/footwear/apparel by large companies from **19 July 2026** (medium firms 2030; micro/small exempt), confirmed by the Austrian Bundeskanzleramt. The Commission estimates 4–9% of EU textiles are destroyed before use. This creates a supply tailwind — surplus goods must be re-used/recycled, potentially feeding re-use channels — though delegated exemptions (Feb 2026) leave loopholes.
- **Right to Repair Directive** and ESPR reporting obligations reinforce circularity.
- **Bundes-Abfallwirtschaftsplan 2023 (BAWP)**: Austria's federal waste plan (7th update); re-use (second-hand, repair, Mehrweg) is an explicit top-priority waste-prevention measure, with ~90 measures including the Reparaturbonus. Sets policy direction favoring re-use; no specific binding kg/capita re-use target was verified.
- **VAT margin scheme (Differenzbesteuerung, §24 UStG 1994)**: A dealer (Wiederverkäufer) who commercially trades used goods bought within the EU from parties owing no VAT (i.e. **private individuals**) taxes only the **margin** (sale price minus purchase price), not the full price; no input-VAT deduction; the invoice must note the scheme (e.g. "Anwendung der Differenzbesteuerung gemäß § 24 UStG 1994") and must not show VAT separately. WKO: *"Das Ziel der Bestimmung ist die Vermeidung von Doppelbelastungen … wenn Wiederverkäufer bestimmte Warengruppen wie z.B. Gebrauchtgegenstände … von Privaten zukaufen."* Standard VAT is **20%** (applies to used goods, on the margin). Both item-by-item (Einzeldifferenzbesteuerung) and aggregate (Gesamtdifferenzbesteuerung, useful for bulk low-value goods) methods exist.
- **Consignment (Kommissionsgeschäft)**: Under §3(3) UStG a sales commission is treated as **two successive supplies**, with the private consignor's deemed supply to the shop occurring **only when the shop sells the item on** — which precisely matches the conto-vendita model where sellers are paid only after sale. Because the consignor's deemed supply carries no VAT (private person), the shop can, in the domestic case, apply the §24 margin scheme on its onward sale. **Caveat: no dedicated Austrian ruling stating verbatim "a private-consignor second-hand shop may use Differenzbesteuerung" was located; this is a well-founded synthesis of §3(3), §24 and UStR treatment of own-name sellers, and must be confirmed by a Steuerberater for the specific franchise contract. Critically, the answer differs depending on whether the shop contracts "im eigenen Namen" (own-name commission → margin scheme) vs. "im fremden Namen" (disclosed broker → only the commission is taxable at 20%, seller's sale is a non-taxable private sale).**

- **Kleinunternehmer (small-business) VAT exemption**: threshold **€55,000 gross/year** (since 2025, unchanged 2026; up from €35,000 net through 2024), with a 10% tolerance to €60,500; it is a non-genuine exemption (no output VAT, but no input-VAT deduction). A consignment shop's gross turnover (measured on full sale prices, not margins) will typically exceed this quickly, so most such shops will operate under normal VAT with the margin scheme.
- **Franchise law**: Austria has **no dedicated franchise statute**. The franchise agreement is a "Vertrag sui generis" governed by general contract, distribution, trademark, competition/cartel and consumer-protection law; each element (trademark licence, equipment lease, goods supply, training) is judged under the nearest named contract type. Pre-contractual disclosure duties, territory protection, non-compete (max ~1 year, limited scope) and post-term compensation are handled contractually — legal review is essential.
- **Business registration**: General retail trade (Handelsgewerbe) is a **free trade (freies Gewerbe)** — no proof of qualification, but mandatory registration with the Bezirksverwaltungsbehörde (Bezirkshauptmannschaft/Magistrat); WKO membership is automatic. Altwarenhandel additionally carries the provenance-documentation duty.

7. Economic & Site-Selection Factors

- **Purchasing power (RegioData)**: Salzburg leads Austria — €29,814 (2024/25 data) rising to **€30,954 (2026)**, ahead of Lower Austria (€30,476) and Upper Austria (€29,669); Vorarlberg (€29,595) and Tyrol (€29,525) also high. Vienna is below the national average (~€27,326) but highly heterogeneous (1st district €44,686–46,826; Rudolfsheim-Fünfhaus ~€22,600). Nominal purchasing power rose ~5% in 2025 and is again rising in real terms as inflation falls below ~3%.
- **Rents**: Residential asking rents (ImmoScout24, gross incl. utilities): Innsbruck the most expensive (€24.23/m² in 2026), Salzburg ~€21.96, Bregenz ~€20, Vienna ~€20.42 (Q1 2025); Graz ~€13.64, Linz ~€15.51, St. Pölten and Eisenstadt cheapest. These are residential (not retail high-street) rents but indicate the relative cost ranking: **Salzburg/Innsbruck expensive; Graz/Linz materially cheaper.** Retail-specific rents must be sourced directly from commercial brokers (research gap).
- **Synthesis**: Salzburg combines the highest purchasing power with high rents and only modest second-hand spend (€205/capita) — attractive customers but expensive floor space. Graz (Styria) offers a dense existing re-use culture (highest furniture-provider density, €219/capita spend) at lower rents. Linz/Upper Austria is mid-cost with a strong social-economy presence.

8. Italy Comparison — Osservatorio Second Hand Economy 2025 (12th edition)

Produced by **Ipsos Doxa for Subito** (naming note below). Method, confirmed verbatim by Subito: *"Realizzato da Ipsos Doxa per Subito a febbraio 2026, su un campione rappresentativo della popolazione italiana attraverso 2.001 interviste CATI + CAWI."* This is the 12th edition.

- **Total market value: €27.2 billion (2025) = 1.2% of Italian GDP** (was €27bn in 2024)
- **Population who bought/sold second-hand in past 12 months: 65% (2025)**, +2 pts vs 2024 = **28.2 million Italians** (+3.7% YoY)
- **68%** of Italians now start a product search from the second-hand market (+9 pts)
- Frequency: **24% of buyers and 23% of sellers transact at least monthly**; over half at least every 6 months
- **Online = 54% of value (€14.7bn)**; digital adoption 71% of Italians (was 30% ten years ago)
- **Category value ranking 2025: Vehicles €11.1bn (largest); Casa & Persona (home & person) €7.4bn; Electronics €5.5bn; Sport & Hobby €3.2bn.** The €27.2bn headline **includes used vehicles (€11.1bn)**, the main reason it dwarfs Austria's ~€2bn.
- Online most-bought categories: Clothing & Accessories (rose from 22% to 43% in five years), Books & Magazines (31%), Furniture & Homeware (25%); vintage clothing is the 2025 "star"
- Motivations: earning/saving is #1 (62% of buyers, 42% of sellers); helps the household budget for 59%
- Historical trend: ~44% of population in 2015, rising each year to 65% in 2025; value €26bn (2023) → €27bn (2024) → €27.2bn (2025)

Naming clarification (Ipsos Doxa vs BVA Doxa): Both refer to the same institute. Doxa is the Italian arm of The BVA Family. **Ipsos completed its acquisition of The BVA Family on 24 June 2025**; the Italian teams now operate as **"Ipsos Doxa"** (France as "Ipsos BVA," UK BDRC as "Ipsos"). Hence the 2024 report appeared under "BVA Doxa" and the 2025 (12th) edition under "Ipsos Doxa" — a rebrand following the acquisition, not two different institutes.

Mercatino context (Italy): Mercatino S.r.l. (Verona, founded 1989; brand from 1995) pioneered the "conto terzi/conto vendita" (consignment) format in Italy, with **~175–180 shops** (mostly franchised, ~~1 direct), typically **400+ m²**, omnichannel with proprietary e-commerce/app. It surpassed **€100m turnover** and, under CEO Sebastiano Marinaccio, announced a 3-year international plan targeting Spain, UK, Germany and France (plus one existing shop in Ibiza), aiming for ~40 new stores. Competing Italian franchises: Mercatopoli (~~56–100 shops, 500 m², ~€60k investment), Babybazar (kids, ~27 shops), OkiDoki (fashion). Franchise entry investments in Italy start ~€10k–60k depending on format.

9. Comparability Analysis

Metric	Austria	Italy (Osservatorio 2025)	Comparable?
Market value	~€2bn (Handelsverband top-down estimate)	€27.2bn (Ipsos Doxa, incl. vehicles)	**No — not apples-to-apples.** Italy includes used vehicles (€11.1bn); Austria's €2bn appears to exclude vehicles and is a round-number estimate. Ex-vehicles Italy is ~€16bn; adjusted for population (IT ~59m vs AT ~9.1m), Italy is still ~2–3× Austria per capita.
% of GDP	~0.4% (implied, unverified scope)	1.2% (defined)	Weak comparability; scopes differ.
% bought/sold in 12 months	~60% bought (Repubblika); resale 3-in-4 ever	65% bought OR sold (n=2,001)	**Partially** — Austria separates buy vs sell; Italy combines.
Avg annual spend	€211 (buyers)	Not stated in same €/capita form	Not directly comparable.
Monthly buyers	18%	24%	Similar direction; different sampling.
Online share	55% of buyers buy online regularly	54% of market value	**Different denominators** (% of buyers vs % of value) — not directly comparable.
Top categories	Clothing, books/media, toys, furniture/home	Fashion/vintage, books, furniture/home (online); vehicles/home/electronics (by value)	**Qualitatively similar** ex-vehicles.

Metric	Austria	Italy (Osservatorio 2025)	Comparable?
Methodology	Retail-association survey (Repubblika) + top-down estimate; BCG luxury-resale growth cited secondhand	Dedicated 12-year observatory, 2,001 interviews, consistent series	Italy far more robust/longitudinal.

Bottom line for the dossier: Present Austria and Italy side-by-side only with explicit caveats. The Italian Osservatorio is a mature, consistent, large-sample survey; the Austrian data is a patchwork of a smaller retail-association survey and a single top-down €2bn estimate with unclear category scope and a secondhand-cited (luxury-resale) BCG growth rate. Do not state "Austria's market is X% the size of Italy's" without noting vehicle inclusion and methodology differences.

Recommendations

Stage 1 — Validate the consignment economics (before any lease):

- Commission a Steuerberater opinion confirming that Mercatino's conto-vendita model qualifies for the §24 UStG margin scheme in Austria, and clarifying whether the shop should contract "im eigenen Namen" (own-name commission, enabling the margin scheme) vs. as a disclosed broker (only the commission is taxable). This materially affects margins and is the single biggest fiscal unknown.
- Model unit economics against Austrian realities: retail rents (obtain retail-specific quotes for Graz, Linz and Salzburg), Austrian wage costs, and the fact that charities source stock for free while Mercatino pays consignors a share of the sale price.
- **Threshold that would change the plan:** if the effective VAT/margin structure plus rent pushes gross margin below ~40–45% (Mercatino's Italian model economics), reconsider city choice or store format/size.

Stage 2 — Field interviews (already planned by the user): prioritize (a) RepaNet/Re-Use Austria on the social-economy sourcing landscape and whether a for-profit consignment model is seen as competitive or complementary; (b) willhaben on category listing volumes (furniture, home) to size the pool of "sellers who would prefer a managed consignment service"; (c) 2–3 existing Austrian vintage/second-hand shop owners on stock sourcing and footfall.

Stage 3 — Pilot city selection: Lead candidates for a first store are **Graz** or **Linz**, not Salzburg: lower rents, an existing dense re-use culture and consumer familiarity (Styria has the highest furniture-provider density and €219/capita spend), and large price-sensitive, sustainability-oriented student populations. Salzburg (the user's base) has the highest purchasing power but expensive floor space and only average second-hand spend — better positioned as store #2 once the model is proven. Vienna offers scale but the most competition and the lowest per-capita second-hand spend (€190).

- **Threshold to green-light rollout:** a pilot store reaching healthy consignment-inventory turnover and break-even within ~12–18 months before signing additional master-franchise territory commitments.

Stage 4 — Positioning: Differentiate from charities (curated "usato firmato"/branded quality, guaranteed payout to sellers, professional retail environment) and from willhaben/Vinted (no listing effort for the seller, physical trust, immediate transaction). Use the ESPR unsold-textile ban and Austria's re-use policy as a B2B sourcing and PR angle.

Caveats & Information Gaps

- **The €2bn market size and the ~10%/year BCG growth rate are both secondhand-cited estimates**, not primary/audited figures. The €2bn is a Handelsverband round-number estimate of unclear category scope; the 10% growth rate derives from BCG's global secondhand-*luxury* study (with Vestiaire Collective), not an Austria-wide general-goods forecast. Treat both as directional only.
- **Institute/naming**: the November 2025 Austrian second-hand consumer study is by **Repubblika Research for the Handelsverband**, not IHaM. IHaM (JKU Linz) publishes separate retail-climate and general consumption studies. The brief's attribution should be corrected.
- **Age-cohort breakdowns** for Austrian second-hand behaviour were not found in primary sources — a genuine gap requiring IHaM or Statista Consumer Insights.
- **Retail (not residential) rents** for high-street/retail units in each candidate city need direct sourcing from commercial brokers (EHL, Otto Immobilien, CBRE Austria).
- **Non-furniture physical provider counts** (clothing, electronics, general) are not mapped nationally — the BOKU study is furniture-only.
- **No confirmed binding kg/capita re-use target** in the BAWP was verified; only qualitative priority.
- **Whether any Mercatino/Mercatopoli-style chain has attempted and failed in Austria/Germany** could not be confirmed and is worth a targeted check, as it would help explain the whitespace.
- **Consignment + margin-scheme eligibility**, while well-founded on §3(3)/§24 UStG, has interpretive uncertainty and must be confirmed by an Austrian tax adviser for the specific franchise contract structure (own-name commission vs. disclosed brokerage).